

Maplewood Community Hospital

Discharge instructions - Heart failure

Patient: Ruth Alvarez, age 78

Discharged: Friday 2 October 2026

Doctor: Dr. Amara Okafor, cardiology

Questions after you get home: heart failure nurse line 555-0142

Why you were in hospital

You stayed 3 nights for a heart failure flare. Extra fluid built up in your legs and lungs. It has been removed with stronger water pills.

Your medicines

- CHANGED: Furosemide (water pill) is now 40 mg every morning at 8 am with breakfast. It was 20 mg. Never take it in the evening.
- NO CHANGE: Lisinopril 10 mg every morning.
- NO CHANGE: Metoprolol succinate 25 mg every evening.
- STOP: Do not take ibuprofen (Advil) or naproxen (Aleve). They make heart failure worse. Use acetaminophen (Tylenol) for pain.

Weigh yourself every day

Weigh yourself every morning after using the toilet and before breakfast. Write the number on your weight sheet.

Call the heart failure nurse line (555-0142) if

- Your weight goes up more than 3 lb overnight or 5 lb in a week.
- Your ankles or legs are more swollen.
- You are more short of breath when walking, or need extra pillows to sleep.

Call 911 if

You have chest pain, you faint, or you have severe trouble breathing at rest.

Food and drink

- Keep salt under 2,000 mg a day. Avoid canned soup and deli meat.
- Drink no more than 1.5 litres of fluid a day (about 6 cups), including soup and tea.

Activity

Walk short distances every day with your walker. Lock both walker brakes before you stand up or sit

down.

Appointments

- Blood test: Tuesday 6 October 2026, 9:00 am, Maplewood lab, ground floor.
- Heart clinic follow-up: Thursday 8 October 2026, 10:30 am, with Dr. Amara Okafor.